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Citizenship: Republic of Korea (F-1 Visa)

Fields of Concentration:

Primary Fields: Industrial Organization

Secondary Fields: Applied Microeconomics, Econometrics

Qualifying Examinations Completed:

2023: Industrial Organization and Econometrics (*with distinction*)

Dissertation Title: *Essays on Market Competition and Policy Design*

Committee:

Professor Katja Seim (Chair)

Professor Steven T. Berry

Professor Philip A. Haile

Education:

Ph.D., Economics, Yale University, 2027 (expected)

M.Phil., Economics, Yale University, 2025

M.A., Economics, Seoul National University, 2021

B.A., Economics, Seoul National University, 2019 (*summa cum laude*)

Fellowships, Honors and Awards:

University Dissertation Fellowship, Yale University, 2026 – 2027

Arvid Anderson Prize Fellowship, Yale University, 2025 – 2026

Nathan Hale Fellowship, Yale University, 2024

Young Economist, 7th Lindau Nobel Laureate Meeting on Economic Sciences, 2022

SBS Scholarship (Full Overseas PhD Funding), SBS Foundation, 2021 – 2027

Cowles Foundation Fellowship, Yale University, 2021 – 2027

Highest Honor Undergraduate Thesis, Seoul National University, 2019

Presidential Eminence Scholarship, Seoul National University, 2018

Teaching Experience:

Introduction to Probability and Statistics, Prof. Yusuke Narita, Yale University, Fall 2025
Math Camp: Computation (PhD), Department of Economics, Yale University, Summer 2025
Introductory Microeconomics, Prof. Cormac O'Dea, Yale University, Fall 2024
Econometrics II (PhD), Prof. Max Cytrynbaum, Yale University, Spring 2024
Econometrics I (PhD), Prof. Donald W. K. Andrews, Yale University, Fall 2023
Basic Computing, Prof. Hyunjoo Kim, Seoul National University, Spring 2021
Studies in Econometrics (PhD), Prof. Yoon-Jae Whang, Seoul National University, Fall 2020

Research Experience:

Research Assistant to Prof. Katja Seim, 2025
Research Assistant to Prof. Yoon-Jae Whang, 2019 – 2021
Research Assistant to Prof. Sukjin Han, 2018 – 2020

Publications:

“Testing for Time Stochastic Dominance” with Oliver Linton and Yoon-Jae Whang, 2023, *Journal of Econometrics*, 235(2), 352-371.
- Best Student Paper Prize, Korean Economic Association, 2020

“Minimum Wage, Social Insurance Mandates, and Work Hours” with Ji Hwan Kim and Jungmin Lee, 2023, *Journal of Public Economics*, 225, 104951.
- Top 50 Outstanding Research, Ministry of Education, Republic of Korea, 2024
- Korean Economy Research Award, Korean Economic Association, 2023

“Testing for Stochastic Dominance in Stata” with Yoon-Jae Whang, forthcoming, *Stata Journal*.

Working Papers:

“The Effects of Service Integration on Platform Competition and Welfare: Evidence from Fulfillment by Amazon,” 2026 [Job Market Paper]

“Copyright and Competition: Estimating Supply and Demand with Unstructured Data” with Sukjin Han, 2025
- Extended Abstract at *26th ACM Conference on Economics and Computation*

“Censorship and Steering in Platform Duopolies” with Michael C. Wang, 2026.

Works in Progress:

“Automation with Market Power: Amazon’s Robotic Warehouses and the Distribution of Welfare”

Seminar and Conference Presentations:

2027: NYC Media Seminar (expected)
2026: ESIF Economics and AI+ML Meeting; Yale FDS: AI for Social Science Workshop
2025: Econometric Society World Congress; ACM Conference on Economics and Computation; AI at Yale Symposium
2024: Asia-Pacific Industrial Organization Conference

Referee Service:

American Economic Review

Professional Service:

Organizer, Yale IO Tea

Computer Skills:

Python, Stata, MATLAB, R

Software:

“PySDDTest: Python Package for Stochastic Dominance Tests” with Yoon-Jae Whang, 2025
- Github: <https://github.com/lee-kyungho/pysdtest>

Languages:

Korean (native), English (fluent), Mandarin Chinese (proficient)

References:

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Dissertation Abstract

The Effects of Service Integration on Platform Competition and Welfare: Evidence from Fulfillment by Amazon [Job Market Paper]

I build an equilibrium model of competition between Amazon and Walmart to measure the welfare effects of integrated logistics, Fulfillment by Amazon (FBA), in the U.S. e-commerce market. FBA is a pivotal service of Amazon, which stores and delivers sellers’ products in exchange for fees. More generally, digital platforms extend their role beyond marketplace intermediation by integrating complementary services: Google and Apple, for instance, also operate payment systems for their app markets. Although these digital gatekeepers exert vast influence on the economy and such integration has prompted regulatory scrutiny (*FTC v. Amazon*, 2023; *Epic v. Google*, 2025), little is known about its welfare effects or the appropriate policy response.

Integration creates a welfare trade-off. While integration eliminates double marginalization (DM) arising from marketplace commissions and logistics fees, it allows a platform to make its service exclusive to its own marketplace or more costly to use on a rival platform. Such foreclosure weakens cross-platform competition, with the magnitude of this effect depending on how much

sellers' adoption of integrated logistics raises their costs of multihoming (i.e., selling on both platforms).

The model captures this trade-off: platforms set commission rates and logistics fees jointly, accounting for consumer choice and sellers' multi-platform entry, logistics adoption, and pricing. I construct a unique dataset linking products and sellers across the two platforms, estimate the model, and document evidence of both pro- and anti-competitive effects of integration: the platforms hold logistics fees down substantially to increase commission profits, yet sellers who use FBA are much less likely to sell on Walmart. The latter finding is further supported by a regression discontinuity design that exploits jumps in Amazon's logistics fee schedule.

On net, counterfactual separation of FBA from Amazon would reduce consumer welfare by 19%: although separation removes exclusivity and increases sellers' multihoming by 91%, it introduces DM and raises logistics fees and commission rates, which raise consumer prices by 25%. Aggregate seller profits change little (+3%), yet separation substantially reduces the profits of small and medium-sized sellers and increases earnings inequality among sellers. I further show that a counterfactual policy that removes exclusivity while preserving integration, such as making integrated logistics interoperable without discriminatory fees, would raise consumer welfare by 38%.

Copyright and Competition: Estimating Supply and Demand with Unstructured Data, with Sukjin Han

We study the competitive and welfare effects of copyright in creative industries in the face of cost-reducing technologies such as generative artificial intelligence (genAI). Copyright restricts entrants that are substantially similar to incumbents, providing local protection in a space of high-dimensional, unstructured attributes. We develop an empirical framework to evaluate the effects of different levels of protection stringency and apply it to a design product: fonts. Using data from the world's largest font marketplace, we construct a visual characteristics space and quantify similarity through neural network embeddings. We use human-labeled tags and a pixel-level mean-variance analysis to reveal the design attributes (e.g., boldness and script) reflected in each embedding dimension. Regression and event-study analyses show that visually similar entrants decrease competitors' sales by 5%, indicating local competition in this visual space and suggesting direct impacts of copyright protection on competition. We then build a model of supply and demand that incorporates the embeddings. Consumers have heterogeneous preferences over designs. Font producers make pricing, entry, and product-positioning decisions in the visual space under copyright-based similarity constraints. Our estimates indicate that consumers prefer visual diversity, but producers can reduce entry costs by mimicking existing designs. Counterfactual analyses show that stricter protection raises social welfare by encouraging entry of designs that consumers prefer, yet the optimal level of protection depends on how genAI affects cost structures.

Automation with Market Power: Amazon's Robotic Warehouses and the Distribution of Welfare

I evaluate the effects of automation on product and labor markets and study how market power shapes the distribution of welfare among consumers, workers, and the firm in the context of Amazon's adoption of robotic warehouses. In a competitive benchmark, adoption lowers variable costs and improves service quality, which benefits consumers. Amazon, however, can exert product market power to retain part of these gains. The retained share depends on the firm's optimal pass-through of cost declines and hence the shape of consumer demand. The effects on the labor market are ambiguous: adoption may expand scale yet displace labor, and labor market power further complicates the net effects. Using data on labor market outcomes, consumer expenditure and warehouse characteristics, I first exploit the staggered introduction of Amazon's robotic warehouses in an event-study design. I find that adoption decreases wages but increases employment in local labor markets. I then build an empirical model in which consumers allocate expenditures across retail stores, workers choose whether to work at an Amazon facility, and Amazon exerts both product and labor market power. I use the model to measure the aggregate and distributional impacts of robot adoption with and without each form of market power, and to conduct policy analyses including minimum wage increases and antitrust enforcement.